

Capstone Team Norms

Table of Contents:

Communication & Collaboration Method(s)	Error! Bookmark not defined.
Client Communication	Error! Bookmark not defined.
Punctuality & Attendance	Error! Bookmark not defined.
Meeting Times, Locations & Management	Error! Bookmark not defined.
Expectations	Error! Bookmark not defined.
Conflict Resolution	Error! Bookmark not defined.
Strikes	Error! Bookmark not defined.
Member Removal Policy	Error! Bookmark not defined.
Agreement	4

Team Charter: Communication, Collaboration, and Expectations

Communication & Collaboration Methods

- **Primary communication:** Group chat on **Discord Messenger**.
 - Members must check at least **once per day** during the project.
- **Secondary communication:** Email (used if a member cannot be reached on Discord).
- **Collaboration tools:**
 - **Google Drive (Docs)** → document collaboration
 - **GitHub** → version control and code collaboration
- **Help & deadlines:**
 - Members are encouraged to **ask for help before soft deadlines** rather than miss them.
- **Escalation:**
 - Program administration may be contacted, but members should first attempt to resolve issues internally.

Client Communication

- **Any group member** may communicate with the client.
 - **Written correspondence:**
 - Proofread by at least **one other member** before sending.
 - **CC all group members and instructor** on any emails.
 - **Oral communication (calls, meetings):**
 - Must be documented.
 - A written summary is to be shared with all members and the instructor.
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Punctuality & Attendance

- Meeting/class attendance should be confirmed **at least one day in advance**.
 - If unable to attend or arriving late:
 - Notify the group **as soon as possible** (ideally the day before, minimum 30 minutes before class if missing entirely).
 - **Absentees are responsible** for catching up, reading meeting summaries, and completing assigned work.
 - **Valid reasons:** illness, emergencies, non-reschedulable appointments, transit issues, work conflicts, natural disasters.
 - **Invalid reasons:** oversleeping, lack of motivation, waiting in line for coffee, etc.
 - **Failure to notify/invalid absence:** Results in a **strike** (see Strikes).
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Meeting Times, Locations & Management

- **Default meetings:**
 - Capstone class time
 - Discord voice server project rooms
 - **Additional meetings:** Scheduled as needed.
 - **Decision making:** Requires a **minimum of 3 members (majority)**.
 - **Task assignment:** Only valid if the member is present or has confirmed agreement.
 - **Posting meetings:** Must include time, place, required members, and task descriptions (posted in Discord).
 - **Cancellations:** Announced via Discord; email if a member doesn't confirm.
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Expectations

- All members must contribute a **reasonable share** of work.
 - **Refusal to contribute** will result in a strike.
 - **Deadlines:**
 - Each milestone will have **at least one soft deadline** (preferably two).
 - Members missing the **first soft deadline** must correct issues before the **second soft deadline**.
 - Failure to meet the second deadline → **removal from the group** (see Removal Policy).
 - Group work is subject to **all program policies and expectations**.
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Conflict Resolution

- Issues will first be discussed as a team.
 - If unresolved → **vote**.
 - In case of a tie → consult program administration.
 - For minor disagreements:
 - If time allows, resolution may be decided via a **team chess match**.
 - Otherwise → administration resolves.
 - Severe infractions (policy violations, hate speech, etc.) → **immediate removal process**.
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Strikes

- A **strike** = a formal warning.
 - Strikes are logged in a **version-controlled document**.
 - **Three strikes → removal** (see Removal Policy).
 - Illegal or policy-violating actions are escalated to **administration or law enforcement**.
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Member Removal Policy

- Evidence of infractions presented to the instructor.
 - Upon instructor approval → member removed.
 - Program administration will determine member's project status after removal.
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Coding Expectations

- **Front-end styling:** Maintained via **CSS / MUI**
- **Front-end ↔ back-end communication:**
 - Front-end must provide data in the format required by the back-end (e.g., JSON, URL headers).
 - Front-end developers are responsible for formatting requests according to back-end requirements.
 - Back-End developers are responsible for formatting requests according to the front-end requirements